Response to “Tutorial: notes and questions for Peter” 20261113

Answers to Questions

Qustion 1.
The Priest should fight in the Troll battle, and the mathematics and the outcomes should reflect the party winning the fight by a larger margin.

Question 2.
The numbers should be presented broken into components such that the contribution from the Axe is obvious.

Question 3.
In the Witch fight, the engine is correct on both counts – please adjust the party dice roll so that they still win (only just) against a Witch bearing Ring.

Question 4.
We did not intend to teach the complexities of deliberately falling down a Trap. We will force the party onto level 2 in a different way. Please update the events and introduce more area tiles as follows:

(1) The Dwarf guides past the Trap.
(2) The party explores West, into a Tunnel with exits East and North.
(3) The party explores North, encountering the Whirlpool.
(4) The party attempts to cross the shallows, but falls in.

This gets us back on track with the original script, in the first area on level 2.

Question 5.
Yes, the timing is correct, but in the updated story (Question 4) the first hazard will be avoided.

Question 6.
Two actions is correct.

Question 7.
Ending mid-expedition is correct. We wish to give the novice player just enough experience to make them confident that they know how to play, and curious about what else the game may involve, but leaving the bulk of scenarios for the player to discover in real play.

It would be helpful to include a comment on the tutorial game running score total at the point of leaving it.

Question 8.
The demo does not feel right at all, and does not add anything to the tutorial. Please remove it pending a decision on what to replace it with (if anything).

What we changed or added that your script did not say:

All good.

Things a new player needs that the script does not cover (not built):

- The objective and scoring: what counts, and that the party must walk back out through the Gateway. YES. Please include at the start.
- Treasure: taking, giving, dropping, and carrying capacity. NO. Transferring an item has been covered. We leave it to the player in real games to discover carrying capacity issues and other limitations on what the party can and cannot do.
- Retreat, and what happens when a fight goes wrong. This is not to be part of the events of the tutorial story, but please include (in the lead up to the Witch fight), a mention of the fact that it is possible to retreat at the end of a round if the party should take a casualty.
- The level and deck counter (why deeper levels draw more cards). YES. Please include an explanation of this subsequent to the first draw of a small card.
- Touch and keyboard controls on a phone or tablet. NO. Pending decisions about different platforms.
- The Help button and the bug-report icon (mentioned once, early). NO. This is dependent on further decisions regarding the overall approach to providing Help.

Other Feedback

As a general principle, the Coach should not pre-announce or anticipate what is about to happen in the next card draw. I appreciate that the current implementation is based on my initial script, which includes a description of the next card draw in brackets at the end of each text line – but the information in brackets was intended only to “queue” the card draw relevant to the next step - not information to be relayed to the player before the card is drawn.

A preliminary Coach Card is needed before Step 1, which introduces itself as a Coach Card, explaining in plain text that the Coach Card can be dragged to any position on the screen and also snapped back. Then for all future Coach Cards it is OK to rely upon the tooltip pop-up that is active over the uppermost area of the card, which ideally could be slightly different shade, to suggest that it is a drag bar.